
FACULTY RESEARCH STRATEGY

From Vision to Practice

Implementing a Research Strategy for the
Faculty of Computing, Digital and Data

Matt Smith

Track record of successful faculty research activity

National ARC Hub for ICT

€32.2m hub hosted at TU Dublin, led by Prof Sarah Jane Delany (2026)

ARC Hub projects

5 Faculty-led: Happy Maths, ISL Translate, Road AI, XRStream, AI-Go

Child online safety

GroSafe €1.5m, Research Ireland NCF (2024–25); N-Light (2021)

Sustainable digital tech

CSDT: €1m+ in new AI funding, five postdocs (2025)

Skills & inclusion

CSINC: €1m HEA plus €0.9m Dept of Education (2025)

EU projects

SignON (H2020, 2021–23); HCAIM human-centred AI master's (CEF)

The Faculty today

~160 academic staff

98 PURE profiles

1,523 PURE outputs

TU Dublin 2028 research targets

23%

Stretch: 25%

research-active academic staff

5%

Stretch: 6.5%

PGRs as share of L8–L10
enrolments

€32m

Stretch: €40m

research funding awards

Stretch figures depend on lifting constraints and a new workload model.

Policy and funding are moving towards digital, GenAI, trust & sustainability

TU Dublin

- **Strategic Plan 2024–28:** People, Planet, Partnership
- **R&I Strategy:** five priorities, incl. Transformative Digital Solutions
- **EUt+:** European University of Technology alliance

Ireland

- **Impact 2030 & Research Ireland:** SFI + IRC merged (Aug 2024)
- **Digital Ireland:** National Digital & AI Strategy (Feb 2026)
- **AI capacity:** AI Office of Ireland; ICHEC-led AI Factory Antenna

Europe

- **FP10:** €175bn proposed for 2028–34, up from ~€96bn
- **Twin transition:** green & digital; Competitiveness Fund digital window
- **EU AI Act:** obligations phasing in; EuroHPC AI Factories

>> Funding favours digital, AI, trust, sustainability and consortia.
>> We need to be bid-ready before the first FP10 calls in 2028.

By 2032, the Faculty is Ireland's go-to partner for *sustainable, applied, trustworthy* computing, data and AI research.

G1 · Nurturing talent

New Talent & Projects

Increase PhD and postdoc community,
& actively explore industry collaborations

Nurture Performing Staff

Help active researchers exploit TU Dublin supports

Activate Staff Potential

Path for research-inactive staff who want to
become more active & learn about research

**G2 · Environment, culture
& collaboration**

Capacity & Funding

More staff research-active,
with protected time;

Research Ireland, FP10 and EUt+
enterprise collaborations

G3 · Engagement

Impact

Measurable benefit for
enterprise,
public services and policy

Proposals:

P1 Data collection & recording

Identify methods and sources of data to inform and measure status and progress of faculty research

P2 Faculty doctoral community

Faculty RS inductions and events
Regular meet-ups & seminars
RS & supervisor community building

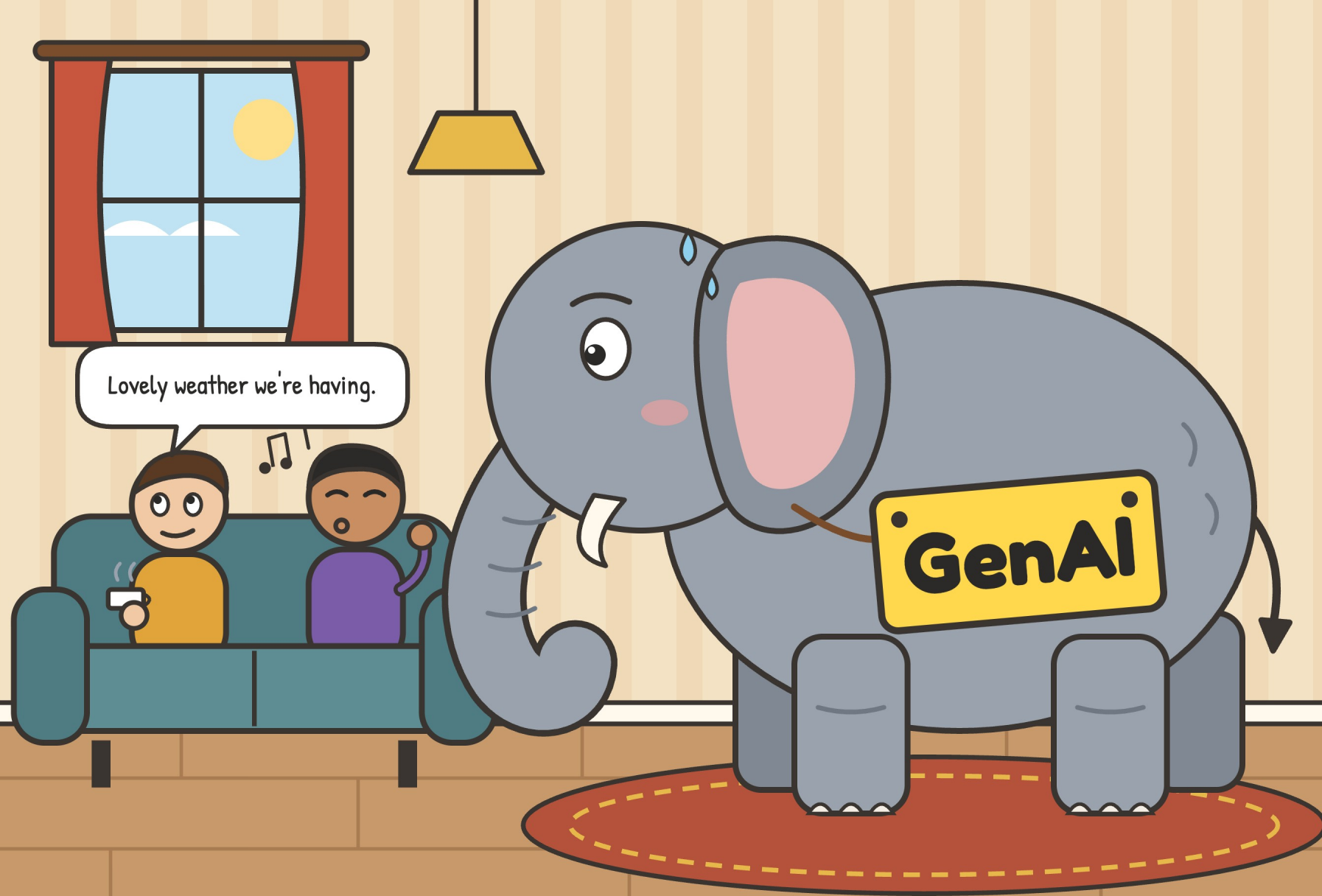
P3 Nurturing research talent

Focussed research periods (e.g. EUT+, Erasmus), funding of teaching buy-outs (e.g. ARCHub ICT)
Pursue workload model that ring-fences research hours, renewed on outputs

P4 Faculty/University Impact desk

One front door for industry and public bodies; spin-out and policy support

P5 GenAI Consult and run a SWOT analysis on GenAI and faculty research



The elephant in the room.



LM Studio

File

Edit

View

Window



99%



Update available



MLX

qwen/qwen3.6-35b-a3b



Java Hello World for Head of Rese



qwen/qwen3.6-35b-a3b

> Thought for 24.50 seconds

Here's a clean, ready-to-run Java implementation that matches your request:

java

Copy

```
public class Main {  
    public static void main(String[] args) {  
        System.out.println("Hello World to the Head of Research post interview team!");  
    }  
}
```

Copy code to clipboard

write a Java Main class to say hello world to the Head of Research post interview team



Think



Vision



0%



An impact desk: one front door for enterprise

University-wide

Trinity Innovation

- KnEx for contracts, IP and consultancy; LaunchBox incubator
- SME "Ways to Engage" event with EI/IUA; vouchers, micro-credentials
- **Lesson:** one brand, SME-sized entry points

University + college

NovaUCD

- R&D collaboration, licensing, ConsultUCD
- College page maps SME schemes: vouchers to €200k grants
- **Lesson:** translate funding schemes for SMEs

College / faculty

Glasgow Sci & Eng

- Five routes: research, KTPs, facilities, funding, contracts
- Named team, one contact form, case studies
- **Lesson:** a short menu and visible people

For CDD: a Faculty front end to TU Dublin Hothouse and Enterprise Engagement

Four routes on one page: collaborate, consult, hire talent, start up

Expertise and facilities you can search by research theme

One named contact; a reply within five working days

Plain guide to vouchers, EI and Research Ireland schemes

Research careers for the staff we already have

Permanent academics

- Protected research hours in the workload model, renewed on outputs
- PhD fee waivers for staff, ring-fenced in the Faculty budget
- Free places on research skills modules: integrity and ethics, academic writing, AI, sustainability
- Each new researcher paired with an experienced PI

Contract researchers

- Faculty roll-out of TU Dublin's Researcher Career Development Framework
- Career conversations every six months; 25 hours of formal learning a year
- Up to 100 teaching hours, so teaching builds a CV rather than replacing research
- Supported route to Pathway and MSCA fellowships

The principle:

grow research capability from the staff we already have.

Measure progress

Proposed Faculty KPI	2025/26	2029	2032
Research-active staff	[__]%	≥30%	≥40%
PGR students enrolled	[__]	+25%	×2
Research awards p.a.	€[__]m	+30%	×2
EU bids submitted p.a.	[__]	10	15 (3 led)
Industry / public co-funded projects p.a.	[__]	10	20
Spin-outs & licences (total)	[__]	1	4
Open-access outputs	[__]%	90%	100%

Thank you

Questions?

Appendix: documents referenced

TU Dublin

Strategic Plan 2024–2028 (PDF):

tudublin.ie/media/website/explore/about-the-university/strategic-plan/documents/Strategic-Plan-2024-2028-FINAL.pdf

Research & Innovation Strategy: tudublin.ie/research-innovation/vice-president-office-for-r-and-i/research-and-innovation-strategy/

Researcher Career Development Framework (PDF, 2024): tudublin.ie/media/website/research/support-for-researchers/early-career-researcher-development/documents/TU-Dublin-RCD-Framework.pdf

Professional Skills Development modules (PDF):

tudublin.ie/media/website/research/postgraduate-research/graduate-research-school/documents/Professional-Development-Modules.pdf

PURE — Faculty of Computing, Digital and Data:

researchprofiles.tudublin.ie/en/organisations/faculty-of-computing-digital-and-data-2/

School of Computer Science — research centres:

tudublin.ie/.../school-of-computer-science/research/research-centres--groups/

School of Informatics & Cybersecurity — research:

tudublin.ie/.../informatics-and-cybersecurity/research/

Hothouse / business incubation: tudublin.ie/connect/enterprise-engagement/business-incubation/

TU Dublin news & projects

National ARC Hub for ICT launch (€32.2m): tudublin.ie/research-innovation/news/national-arc-hub-for-ict-at-tu-dublin-launched...

ARC Hub project list: ict.archhub.ie/arc-hub-for-ict-projects/

GroSafe +€500k (Dec 2024): tudublin.ie/research-innovation/news/archive-2024/tu-dublins-grosafe-project-secures-500000...

GroSafe €1m prize (Dec 2025): researchireland.ie/news/national-challenge-fund-second-cohort-prize/

Landmark Year 2025 review (CSDT, CSINC): tudublin.ie/research-innovation/news/archive-2025/tu-dublin-celebrates-landmark-year...

CSINC €1m HEA award (Mar 2025):

tudublin.ie/explore/news/archive-2025/tu-dublin-csinc-awarded-1-million...

SignON (CORDIS, project 101017255):

cordis.europa.eu/project/id/101017255

N-Light (Safe Online): safeonline.global/technological-university-dublin/

HCAIM project: humancentered-ai.eu/tud/

National, EU and comparators

Impact 2030 (strategy PDF):

assets.gov.ie/static/documents/impact-2030-irelands-research-and-innovation-strategy.pdf · HEA page

Digital and AI Strategy (gov.ie): gov.ie/en/department-of-enterprise-tourism-and-employment/policy-information/digital-and-ai-strategy/

National Training Fund €1.5bn (gov.ie): gov.ie/.../unlocking-funding-package-of-15-billion/

Research Ireland funding: researchireland.ie/funding/

Technological Universities Act 2018, s.28:

irishstatutebook.ie/eli/2018/act/3/section/28/enacted/en/html · revised text

AI Factory Antenna (Silicon Republic):

siliconrepublic.com/innovation/ireland-ai-factory-antenna-eurohpc-supercomputer

FP10 / European Competitiveness Fund: forwit.at/en/blog/fp10-horizon-europe-and-the-competitiveness-fund/

Comparators: [Trinity Innovation](#) · [Irish Times](#), [Trinity and SMEs](#) · [NovaUCD](#) · [UCD Eng & Arch](#) · [Glasgow Science & Engineering](#)